

## MIDDLE LIFE

As World War II evolved, Father put his business interests on ice and enlisted. Too old and too well educated for ideal cannon fodder, he got lucky. Long-time mentor Ed Heller enlisted ahead of him and pulled some strings—somehow Father was made an instant officer and hence never saw the front line. Instead, he fought the war from behind desks all over mid-America, doing accounting and finance for the Army Air Corps. On day one, he was a lieutenant, which he found awkward. On reporting for duty, in uniform, lower-ranking personnel would salute him, yet he didn't know how to respond. Senior personnel expected respect and appropriate behavior, which he also didn't know how to deliver. It took time to adjust. He hated the military, thought of it as a terrible time, despite admitting quite readily that he was treated well by it. He hated the regimentation, the lack of freedom, and being ordered about. When stationed in Little Rock, Arkansas, he met my mother, Dorothy Whyte, who was also in service there. My mother came from Camden, Arkansas, which is very close to where President Bill Clinton was later raised. Father flipped head over heels for my mother instantly and asked her to marry him only weeks into their relationship; she immediately agreed. In 1944 my eldest brother, Arthur, was born—mother having been sent ahead to San Francisco to be with my grandfather for his medical supervision prior to and after birth. She remained there until Father's discharge, whereupon he returned home and renewed his business interests as described in his monograph. Donald was born in 1947 and I in 1950. In between the birth of Donald and me, a daughter died in childbirth.

Shortly after I was born, they bought a house on the site where they now live in San Mateo, California, twenty minutes south of San Francisco. But they came to hate the house while loving the acre on which the house sat. They loved the views, the trees, and the landscape. Father ripped the house down and built the house in which I was raised and where he and my mother resided ever after. We rented a house a block away during construction. When complete, the house was big, all white, clean, and austere. In my father's house, everything must be neat to a fault. Possessions in all forms were sparse and exactly in their places or they drove him nuts. He